

English Guide @ Level B1/B2

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Abstract

Built by Carmen Crai covering tenses, prepositions, adverbs, modal verbs, linking words and more, up to B2 level.

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EASY AND PRACTICAL GUIDE

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1. Start

This course is built around the priorities below — the grammar and vocabulary areas that make the biggest difference to how clearly and confidently you communicate in English.

[1. Grammar](#): present, past and future tenses (simple, continuous, passive, perfect)

1.1. For **polite conversations** we use:

- present/past/future **passive** simple for instance: “The contract is signed”
- **modal** verbs for example: “Should we ask the client first?”
- **past continuous** e.g.: “I was wondering/thinking if you could help me?”

[2. Prepositions](#): at, in, on, about, for, by, with

[3. Adverbs](#): words ending in “**ly**” that usually describe “**how**” an action is done

[4. Comparison adjectives](#): six types (equality, inequality, comparative, superlative...)

[5. Possessives](#): 's / s' and **possessive** pronouns (mine, yours, theirs, his, hers)

[6. Linking words](#): to clearly **connect ideas** (see [Linking Words chapter](#))

[7. The gerund](#) ing form: as a **noun for example** “**listening is important**” and after **prepositions**

[8. Verbs \(V3\) that become adjectives](#), and **nouns** that act as **adjectives** e.g. “**the requested data**”

[9. Modal verbs](#): can, could, would, should, must, may, might

10. Professional / workplace verbs and vocabulary — see [Appendix J — Extended Professional Words Table](#)

11. At B1/B2 level you must be able to **easily provide synonyms**: for verbs, adjectives, adverbs, linking words and nouns.

2. Grammar: Tenses

In a professional workplace, I only recommend the below grammar to be used:

SIMPLE					
PRESENT	Action in the present taking place regularly , never or several times.		To be (am/are/is) verb describes a person/animal/object : adjectives, job, nationality, location, feelings, presence.		
	A: He speaks. They speak. N: He doesn't speak. They don't speak. Q: Does he speak? Do they speak? Q-: Doesn't he speak? Does he not speak?		A: He is here/good/German. They are great. N: He isn't here/good/German. He is not here/good. They aren't great. They are not great. Q+: Is he here? Are they good people? Q-: Isn't he German? Is he not here? Aren't they here yet? Are they not here yet?		
PAST	Action in the past taking place once, never or several times.		Action taking place now that takes time .		
	A: He spoke. They spoke. N: He didn't speak. They didn't speak. Q: Did he speak? Did they speak? Q-: Didn't he speak? Did he not speak? Did they not speak?		A: He is speaking. They are speaking. N: He is not / isn't speaking. They are not speaking. Q+: Is he speaking? Are they speaking? Q-: Aren't they speaking? Are they not speaking?		
FUTURE	Planned action in the future.		Action that is going on at a certain time in the future.		
	A: He will speak. They will speak. N: He won't speak. They won't speak. Q: Will he speak? Will they speak? Q-: Won't he speak? Will he not speak?		A: He will be speaking. They will be speaking. N: He won't be speaking. They won't be speaking. Q: Will he be speaking? Will they be speaking? Q-: Won't he be speaking? Will he not be speaking?		

For further information, see [Appendix A — Extended Tenses Table](#).

3. Prepositions

Prepositions link nouns, pronouns or gerunds to the rest of the sentence. The three most common are at, in and on, used for time and place.

We arrived at the station at 6 p.m. (precise time / point)

She was born in 1990 and lives in London. (year / city — larger area)

The meeting is on Monday, on the 5th floor. (day / surface)

Further usage:

When	In
parts of the day	☐ <i>in the morning/afternoon/evening</i>
months	☐ <i>in January/February</i>
seasons	☐ <i>in (the) spring/summer/autumn/winter</i>
years, centuries, decades	☐ <i>in 2016</i> ☐ <i>in the 21st century</i> ☐ <i>in the 80s</i>
other time phrases	☐ <i>in the past</i> ☐ <i>in the future</i> ☐ <i>in the last few years/months/weeks/days</i>

When	On
days	☐ <i>on Monday/Tuesday etc.</i> ☐ <i>on my birthday</i> ☐ <i>on New Year's Day</i> ☐ <i>On weekend</i>
dates	☐ <i>on 30 July</i> ☐ <i>on the second of August</i>

When	At
clock times	☐ <i>at 6 o'clock</i> ☐ <i>at 9.30</i> ☐ <i>at 13.00</i>
meal times and breaks	☐ <i>at breakfast time</i> ☐ <i>at lunchtime</i> ☐ <i>at dinner time</i> ☐ <i>at break time</i>
other time phrases	☐ <i>at night</i> ☐ <i>at weekends the weekend</i> ☐ <i>at Christmas/ Easter</i>

For **further prepositions** information, see [Appendix G — Extended Prepositions Notes](#).

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